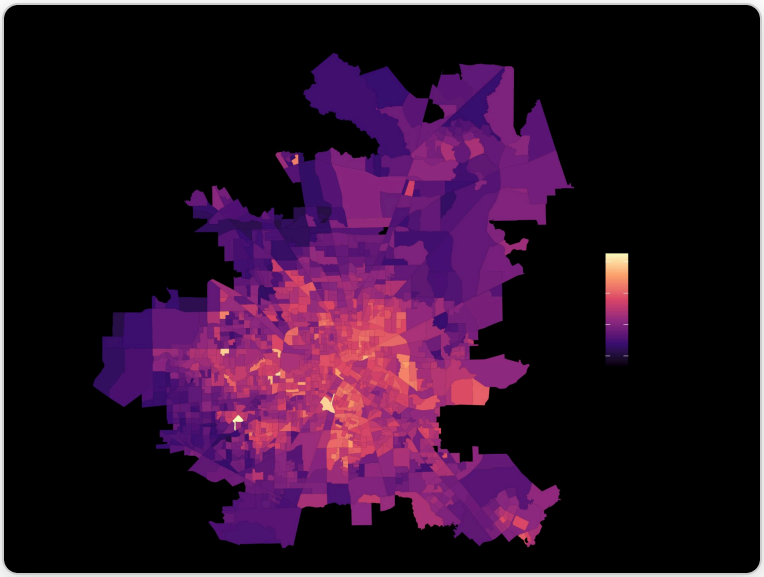
BEAT THE HEAT

HOUSTON HEAT-RELATED ILLNESS PREVENTION GUIDE

1,487
CENSUS BLOCKS ANALYZED

RISK MAP — GREATER HOUSTON AREA



◀ Lower Risk — Higher Risk ▶

What This Map Shows

This map displays *model-predicted relative risk* of heat-related illness across Houston census blocks — accounting for neighborhood conditions, temperature, and population characteristics. Brighter areas face the highest risk above what would normally be expected.

KEY RISK FACTORS IDENTIFIED

No Air Conditioning

Neighborhoods with more homes lacking AC show significantly higher heat illness rates.

↑ RISK

Older Adult Populations (65+)

Areas with more elderly residents face substantially elevated risk — older adults regulate body temperature less effectively.

↑ RISK

Higher Overnight Temperatures

Even nighttime minimums matter — areas with less overnight cooling see significantly more heat illness cases.

↑ RISK

AC Access & Cooler Conditions

Access to air conditioning is the single strongest protective factor against heat-related illness.

↓ RISK

HOW TO STAY SAFE

Stay Hydrated

Drink water every 15–20 min outdoors. Don't wait until you're thirsty.

Use Cooling Centers

Find free AC at libraries, community centers & City of Houston cooling sites.

Check on Neighbors

Check on elderly neighbors and relatives daily during heat advisories.

Avoid Peak Hours

Limit outdoor activity 10 AM–4 PM. Plan errands for early morning.

Dress for the Heat

Wear light, loose-fitting, light-colored clothing and a wide-brimmed hat.

Know the Signs

Heavy sweating, weakness, fast pulse — call 911 for confusion or loss of consciousness.

EMERGENCY
9-1-1

HOUSTON HEALTH DEPT
(832) 393-5080

Houston Health Department | City of Houston Emergency Mgmt | Harris County Public Health

Risk estimates based on spatial statistical analysis of Houston census block data. Summer 2024.